
EMERGENCY
Lower GRADUALLY
Emergency HYDRO Boat
NITRO Pressure Speedboat
MAX SPEED 20 MPH
AUTOREGULATION FAILURE
PRES to release
PRES to release

5.3 - HTN Emergency SOAP

1(O) Broken Red Smokestack:
Severe HTN is generally defined as SBP >180 mmHg and/or DBP >120 mmHg **(Vitals)**

2(O) 180° protractor over 120 cm ruler:
Severe HTN is generally defined as **SBP >180 mmHg and/or DBP >120 mmHg (Vitals)**

3) Oblivious ship captain:
Severe ASYMPTOMATIC HTN (formerly hypertensive urgency) = severe HTN without sx/sy of acute end-organ damage

4(P) Gauges shaped like 160/100 beneath target-shaped light:
Lower BP to a **target of <160/100** over a period of hours to days

5(P) Moving through the hours:
Lower BP to a target of <160/100 **over a period of hours to days**

6(P) Captain popping snacks:
Treat severe asymptomatic hypertension with **oral medications (1)**

7(P) CLAWed bear rug:
Start treatment for severe asymptomatic hypertension with short-acting oral medications like **clonidine** or captopril **(2)**

8(P) ACE cards:
Start treatment for severe asymptomatic hypertension with short-acting oral medications like clonidine or **captopril (2)**

9) Emergency light:
HTN emergency = severe HTN + sx/sy of acute end-organ damage

0) Damaged ship:
HTN emergency = severe HTN + sx/sy of **acute end-organ damage**

11(S) Man getting hit in the head:
Headache and vision changes are the most common presenting symptoms of hypertensive emergency **(Chief Complaint)**

12(S) Man squinting eyes:
Headache and **vision changes** are the most common presenting symptoms of hypertensive emergency **(Chief Complaint)**

13(S) Guy blowing puff of air:
Dyspnea in hypertensive emergency may result from acute pulmonary edema **(Chief Complaint)**

14(S) Wet lung-shaped life vest:
Dyspnea in hypertensive emergency may result from **acute pulmonary edema (Chief Complaint)**

15(S) Man wearing brain bowler hat:
Altered mental status, seizures, & coma are manifestations of **hypertensive encephalopathy (Chief Complaint)**

16(S) Googly-eyed man:
Altered mental status , seizures, & coma are manifestations of hypertensive encephalopathy (Chief Complaint)

17) “PRES to release” door:
Posterior Reversible Encephalopathy Syndrome results from dysfunctional autoregulation (often 2/2 hypertension) → results in vasogenic cerebral edema

18(S) Monocled man:
Focal neurologic symptoms suggest stroke, in contrast to the generalized neurologic symptoms of hypertensive encephalopathy **(HPI)**

19(S) Guitar player hit in the chest:
In hypertensive emergency, **chest pain** can reflect myocardial ischemia or aortic dissection **(HPI)**

20(S) Heart-shaped guitar with broken string:
In hypertensive emergency, chest pain can reflect **myocardial ischemia** or aortic dissection **(HPI)**

21(S) Red pipe with splitting crack:
In hypertensive emergency, chest pain can reflect myocardial ischemia or **aortic dissection (HPI)**

22(S) Broken home med bag with pills spilling out:
Medication non-compliance is the most common cause of severe HTN **(Medications)**

23(S) Man swinging from CLAW hook:
Sudden discontinuation of short-acting antihypertensives (e.g., clonidine) can precipitate severe HTN **(Medications)**

24(S) Trapped mouse:
In patients taking **MAOIs** , eating tyramine-rich foods (e.g., wine, cheese, smoked meats) can classically precipitate hypertensive emergency **(Medications)**

25(S) Fancy rich foods:
In patients taking MAOIs, eating **tyramine-rich foods (e.g., wine, cheese, smoked meats)** can classically precipitate hypertensive emergency **(Medications)**

26(S) Cup of cocoa:
Ask about use of recreational drugs (e.g., **cocaine**, amphetamines, PCP) which can cause hypertensive emergency **(Social Hx)**

27(O) Retina-shaped lifesaver:
Look for signs of hypertensive retinopathy (i.e., flame hemorrhages, cotton-wool spots, papilledema) **(Physical Exam)**

28(O) Flaming debris around retina lifesaver:
Look for signs of hypertensive retinopathy (i.e., **flame hemorrhages**, cotton-wool spots, papilledema) **(Physical Exam)**

29(O) Fluffy white beard next to retina lifesaver:
Look for signs of hypertensive retinopathy (i.e., flame hemorrhages, **cotton-wool spots**, papilledema) **(Physical Exam)**

30(O) Fat white air nozzle on retina lifesaver:
Look for signs of hypertensive retinopathy (i.e., flame hemorrhages, cotton-wool spots, **papilledema**) **(Physical Exam)**

31(O) Crackly velcro:
Listen for signs of acute hypertensive pulmonary edema (e.g., rhonchi, **crackles**) **(Physical Exam)**

32(O) Wet pulmonary life vest:
Listen for signs of acute hypertensive **pulmonary edema** (e.g., rhonchi, **crackles**) **(Physical Exam)**

33(O) Elevated credit cards:
Elevated creatinine suggests acute hypertensive nephrosclerosis **(Labs)**

34(O) Scaly, red knotted rope:
Elevated creatinine suggests **acute hypertensive nephrosclerosis** **(Labs)**

35(O) Specimen cup bucket:
Microscopic hematuria is seen on **UA** in 75% of patients with HTN emergency **(Labs)**

36(O) Magnet rescuing woman floating on “PRES to release” door:
MRI is required for diagnosis of PRES → look for posterior cerebral white matter edema **(Imaging)**

37(O) Woman with big white bonnet:
MRI is required for diagnosis of PRES → look for **posterior cerebral white matter edema (Imaging)**

38(P) “Max Speed 20 MPH”:
In patients with severe HTN, **lower MAP by no more than 20% in the first hour (1)**

39(P) Gauges shaped like 160/110:
Lower BP by an additional 5-10% **(typically ~160/110)** over the next 23 hours **(2)**

40(P) Slowly progressing clocks:
Lower BP by an additional 5-10% (typically ~160/110) **over the next 23 hours (2)**

41(P) Ivy-covered Emergency HYDRO Boat:
Use short-acting IV antihypertensives (e.g., **IV hydralazine**, IV nitroprusside) to lower BP initially in HTN emergency **(2)**

42(P) Ivy-covered NITRO Pressure Speedboat:
Use short-acting IV antihypertensives (e.g., IV hydralazine, **IV nitroprusside**) to lower BP initially in HTN emergency **(2)**

43) Blue exhaust coming from Nitro Pressure Speedboat:
Nitroprusside can cause cyanide toxicity → manifests as altered mental status and/or lactic acidosis

44) Googly-eyed survivor with falling brain hat:
Nitroprusside can cause cyanide toxicity → manifests as **altered mental status** and/or lactic acidosis

45) Lactic milk crate:
Nitroprusside can cause cyanide toxicity → manifests as altered mental status and/or**lactic acidosis**

46(P) Mouth-shaped boat:
Transition to oral antihypertensives after a suitable period (~24 hours) of BP control **(3)**